

to appear on your page, or him/her tagging your bakery in his posts will be a direct boost to your popularity. An excellent example of this is when Shredz, a nutritional supplements company, quintupled their revenue between 2012 and 2013 by partnering with fitness model Paige Hathaway. It helped both parties shoot into fame, with Hathaway's followers count growing from 8,000 to a staggering 1.8 million in three years.

3. **Be cool:** This is not about surviving high school, nor is it about Samuel L Jackson yelling at Amanda Plummer in *Pulp Fiction*. Rather, it's a friendly reminder that being uptight and formal all the time is the wrong way to be going about social media. Throw out the business suit once in awhile and be funny. Informal is the new sexy, and everyone loves a brand that can take the occasional joke.
4. **Shout-out to your followers:** Remember the bit about playing around with hashtags? Well, it pays to bring your followers into the limelight when the post quality original content with your hashtags. It brings them fame, which makes them happy, which makes people in their network more likely to hear about you. Being nice to others helps!
5. **Creativity:** Original content is good; creative original content is even better. Instagram offers a plethora of photo editing options to tweak your images endlessly. As always, moderation is key.
6. **Use analytics tools:** You've heard it a million times before (and a few hundred times in last month's Fast Track to big data) but we're going to say it again - use the power of data analytics to find out who your most active users are and what they're interested in. For example, SEEN Insights provides competitive analysis and product insights for Twitter and Instagram and can really help you gain a clearer picture of whom you're trying to interact with.
7. **Know your competitors:** Aping your rivals may sound like bad advice, but only if it's done badly. It's more about knowing what's working for them and trying to improve on it, and learning from others' mistakes and steering clear of them. Deliberately courting controversy, or handling it poorly on social media is akin to committing hara-kiri.

The flip side

Marketing can be an unforgiving industry, and the pretty, vignettted, HDR-enhanced pictures often hide a rather desperate side to life solely based around achieving fame. It's a natural consequence of an ecosystem whose sole measure of popularity is the number of likes a post has and the number